

There's an impressive consistency in tone across the media.



"Hellboy's set on a certain course. I'm turning corners where there's no going back"

Mignola's style has rightly won acclaim from all quarters. Frankly, it's stunning.



The movie was a very good companion piece to the comic.

story, and my original plan was to give him a 'laundry list' of things I wanted to draw and have him knock it into shape. But by that point, I was making things up fast and, little-by-little, piecing the story together. I soon found there were things John changed that sounded more polished and professional, but they lacked the oddness and quirkiness of what I wrote, and some of the humour didn't translate. John knew this, but all along he'd been saying I should be writing everything anyway; he never tried to make *Hellboy* his book, and he treated himself like bicycle training wheels! I can't thank him enough for that, and at the end of the series, he told me I was on my own!

The scariest moment was when I took over the next one, writing and drawing everything – it was in black and white, so I didn't even have a colourist. But once I relaxed, I found there were so many things I could do as writer and artist.

The *Hellboy* comic is quite cinematic. Was the potential for a movie always at the back of your mind?

It never occurred to me, because I never thought I'd get to do a second *Hellboy* story! I thought I'll do this one, and when no one buys it, I'll limp back to whatever job I can get from Marvel or DC, but I'd at least be able to look back and say I once got to put my personality on the page. When Dark Horse said it was interested in developing a *Hellboy* film, I went: "Sure, I'm happy to take the movie option money, as long as you guys want to keep optioning it, but no one will ever

ESSENTIAL HELLBOY

With many different goodies to choose from, we direct you to the key instalments in the *Hellboy* universe...



Hellboy: Seed Of Destruction
Where it all began, in more ways than one, this trade compiles Hellboy's 'origins' story, and the very first Hellboy stories produced.



Hellboy: The Right Hand Of Doom
The fourth *Hellboy* collection includes a number of shorter stories, including classic folklore adaptation 'Heads'.



B.P.R.D.: Hollow Earth And Other Stories
Spin-off series *B.P.R.D.* concentrates on the other members in Hellboy's team, and is just as compelling as *Hellboy*.



Hellboy Animated: Blood And Iron
The best of the two animated features, *Blood And Iron* has set pieces that would make movie directors drool uncontrollably.



Hellboy: Director's Cut
The director's cut of the movie fleshes out the big-screen intro to Hellboy's world, along with providing hours of engrossing extras.